

ROI Calculator

Migration Savings Across All Scenarios

Fill-in worksheets for VMware exit, Hyper-V migration, cloud repatriation, edge deployment, SQL Server licensing, and multi-cloud consolidation. Pre-calculated examples for small (25 VMs), medium (100 VMs), and large (500 VMs) estates. Every number you need to build the business case.

6 Worksheets | 8 Pre-Calculated Scenarios | Fillable | \$0 Tool Cost | Apache 2.0

Worksheet 1: VMware Exit

Calculate savings from migrating VMware vSphere to KVM/KubeVirt.

A. Current VMware Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
vSphere licenses (per-socket or VCF bundle)	\$ _____	\$5K-15K/socket	Post-Broadcom: 2-12x increase
vCenter Server license	\$ _____	\$6K-10K	Required for management
vSAN / storage licenses	\$ _____	\$2K-8K/socket	If using vSAN
NSX / network licenses	\$ _____	\$4K-12K/socket	If using NSX
Support & maintenance	\$ _____	20-25% of license	Annual SnS renewal
Additional (Horizon, SRM, Aria, etc.)	\$ _____	Varies	All VMware products
A. Total VMware Annual Cost	\$ _____		

B. Migration Investment (One-Time)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
New hardware (if needed)	\$ _____	\$0-50K	Often reuse existing
KVM/K8s training	\$ _____	\$5K-20K	Team upskilling
Migration labor (internal or consulting)	\$ _____	\$10K-50K	1 engineer, 12-20 weeks
Parallel run (VMware overlap)	\$ _____	1-3 mo of license	Keep VMware as rollback
hyper2kvm + hypersdk license	\$0	\$0	Apache 2.0 open source
B. Total Migration Investment	\$ _____		

C. New Annual Costs (KVM/KubeVirt)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
KVM hypervisor licensing	\$0	\$0	In Linux kernel
K3s / KubeVirt licensing	\$0	\$0	CNCF open source
OS subscription (RHEL optional)	\$_____	\$0-800/host/yr	Fedora/Ubuntu = \$0
Hardware maintenance	\$_____	Same as current	Same servers
Linux admin FTEs	\$_____	Same or less	Often same team retrained
C. Total New Annual Cost	\$_____		

D. Results

Metric	Your Number	Formula
Annual Savings	\$_____	= A - C
Payback Period (months)	_____ mo	= B / (Annual Savings / 12)
3-Year Net Savings	\$_____	= (Annual Savings x 3) - B
3-Year ROI	_____ %	= ((Annual Savings x 3) - B) / B x 100

Worksheet 2: Hyper-V Exit

Calculate savings from eliminating Windows Server Datacenter licensing.

A. Current Hyper-V Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
Windows Server Datacenter (per 2-core pack)	\$ _____	\$6,155 x 8 packs/host	\$49K minimum per host
System Center (SCVMM, SCOM, etc.)	\$ _____	\$3,607 x 8 packs/host	If using System Center
Windows Server CALs	\$ _____	\$30-44/user or device	Per user or per device
Software Assurance / renewals	\$ _____	~25% of license/yr	For upgrade rights
A. Total Hyper-V Annual Cost	\$ _____		

B. Migration Investment (One-Time)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical	Notes
Migration labor	\$ _____	\$8K-30K	Typically faster than VMware
Training (Windows admin → Linux/KVM)	\$ _____	\$5K-15K	Biggest learning curve
Hardware (if needed)	\$ _____	\$0 (reuse)	Same servers, install Linux
B. Total Migration Investment	\$ _____		

C. Results

Metric	Your Number	Formula
New annual cost (KVM)	\$ _____	Typically \$0-5K (RHEL optional)
Annual Savings	\$ _____	= A - New Annual Cost
Payback Period	____ mo	= B / (Savings / 12)

3-Year Net Savings

\$_____

= (Savings x 3) - B

Hyper-V hidden cost: Windows Server Datacenter at \$49K/host is often the most expensive single item. A 4-host cluster costs **\$197K in licensing alone** — more than most hardware budgets. Moving to Linux + KVM eliminates this entirely.

Worksheet 3: Cloud Repatriation

Calculate savings from bringing VMs home from AWS, Azure, or GCP.

A. Current Cloud Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
Compute instances (EC2/Azure VMs/GCE)	\$ _____	\$200-2,000/VM/mo	x number of VMs x 12
Block storage (EBS/Managed Disk/PD)	\$ _____	\$0.08-0.17/GB/mo	Provisioned or consumed
Data egress / transfer	\$ _____	\$0.09/GB outbound	Often the hidden killer
Load balancers / NAT gateways	\$ _____	\$20-200/mo each	Per service, per region
Monitoring (CloudWatch/Monitor/Logging)	\$ _____	\$5-50/VM/mo	Logs, metrics, alerts
Reserved instance premium (if applicable)	\$ _____	30-60% of on-demand	Commitment lock-in
A. Total Cloud Annual Cost	\$ _____		

B. On-Prem KVM Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
Server hardware (amortized 5 yr)	\$ _____	\$800-2K/mo equiv	One-time / 60 months
NVMe/SSD storage	\$ _____	\$200-500/mo equiv	Much cheaper than cloud
Network (no egress fees)	\$0	\$0	Local — zero egress
Monitoring (Prometheus/Grafana)	\$0	\$0	Open source
KVM/KubeVirt licensing	\$0	\$0	Open source
Operations staff delta	\$ _____	Often less than cloud	No cloud console complexity
B. Total On-Prem Annual Cost	\$ _____		

C. Results

Metric	Your Number	Formula
Migration investment (one-time hardware + labor)	\$ _____	Typically \$30K-80K
Annual Savings	\$ _____	= A - B
Payback Period	_____ mo	= Investment / (Savings / 12)
3-Year Net Savings	\$ _____	= (Savings x 3) - Investment

Worksheet 4: Edge Deployment

Calculate savings from replacing VMware at remote/branch sites with K3s + KubeVirt.

Cost Item (Per Site)	VMware	K3s + KubeVirt	Savings Per Site
Hypervisor licensing	\$ _____	\$0	\$ _____
Management platform	\$ _____	\$0 (GitOps)	\$ _____
Hardware	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Annual per-site savings			\$ _____
Number of sites		_____	
Total annual savings (all sites)			\$ _____
3-year savings (all sites)			\$ _____

Worksheet 5: SQL Server Licensing

Additional savings from KVM CPU pinning reducing SQL Server per-core costs.

Cost Item	On VMware	On KVM (pinned)	Savings
Physical cores per host	_____	_____ (pinned vCPUs)	
SQL Standard (\$3,945/2-core pack)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
SQL Enterprise (\$15,123/2-core pack)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Number of SQL Server VMs		_____	
Total SQL licensing savings			\$ _____

KVM with CPU pinning exposes only assigned cores to the guest. SQL Server licensing counts visible cores. Typical savings: 20-40% on per-core costs.

Worksheet 6: Combined Total

Source	3-Year Savings	Your Number
VMware exit (Worksheet 1)	\$ _____	
Hyper-V exit (Worksheet 2)	\$ _____	
Cloud repatriation (Worksheet 3)	\$ _____	
Edge deployment (Worksheet 4)	\$ _____	
SQL Server licensing (Worksheet 5)	\$ _____	
GRAND TOTAL 3-YEAR SAVINGS	\$ _____	

Pre-Calculated Examples

Ready-made scenarios — find the one closest to your environment.

Scenario 1: Small Business — 25 VMs, 2 hosts, VMware vSphere Standard

Metric	VMware Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes
Annual licensing	\$35,000	\$0	\$35,000	vSphere + vCenter
Annual support	\$8,750	\$0	\$8,750	25% of license
Annual ops (delta)	\$0	\$0	\$0	Same team
Migration (one-time)	—	\$8,000	-\$8,000	1 engineer, 3 weeks
Annual savings			\$43,750	
Payback			2.2 months	
3-year net savings			\$123,250	

Scenario 2: Mid-Size Enterprise — 100 VMs, 8 hosts, VMware vSphere Enterprise Plus

Metric	VMware Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes
Annual licensing (vSphere+vCenter+vSAN)	\$220,000	\$0	\$220,000	Post-Broadcom pricing
Annual support	\$55,000	\$6,400	\$48,600	RHEL optional
Annual ops (savings)	\$0	-\$15,000	\$15,000	KVM simpler to manage
Migration (one-time)	—	\$35,000	-\$35,000	1 engineer, 16 weeks
Annual savings			\$283,600	
Payback			1.5 months	
3-year net savings			\$815,800	

Scenario 3: Large Enterprise — 500 VMs, 40 hosts, 10 sites, VMware VCF

Metric	VMware Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes
Annual licensing (VCF bundle)	\$1,200,000	\$0	\$1,200,000	VCF at \$30K/socket
Annual support	\$300,000	\$32,000	\$268,000	RHEL sub for all hosts
Annual ops (savings)	\$0	-\$50,000	\$50,000	2 fewer FTEs needed
Migration (one-time)	—	\$100,000	-\$100,000	2 engineers, 20 weeks
Annual savings			\$1,518,000	
Payback			0.8 months	
3-year net savings			\$4,454,000	

More Pre-Calculated Scenarios

Scenario 4: AWS Repatriation — 20 VMs from EC2 to on-prem KVM

Metric	AWS Cost	On-Prem KVM	Savings	Notes
Annual compute (m5.2xlarge x 20)	\$176,000	\$13,333	\$162,667	HW amortized 5yr
Annual storage (EBS 20TB)	\$24,000	\$2,667	\$21,333	NVMe SSDs
Annual egress (5TB/mo)	\$5,400	\$0	\$5,400	Zero egress on-prem
Annual monitoring	\$7,200	\$0	\$7,200	Prometheus free
Migration (one-time)	—	\$15,000	-\$15,000	hypersdk export + convert
Annual savings			\$196,600	
3-year net savings			\$574,800	

Scenario 5: Azure Repatriation — 20 VMs (D8s_v3) to on-prem KVM

Metric	Azure Cost	On-Prem KVM	Savings	Notes
Annual compute	\$153,600	\$13,333	\$140,267	
Annual storage (Managed Disks)	\$29,520	\$2,667	\$26,853	
Annual egress + monitoring	\$12,960	\$0	\$12,960	
Migration (one-time)	—	\$15,000	-\$15,000	
Annual savings			\$180,080	
3-year net savings			\$525,240	

Scenario 6: Hyper-V Exit — 40 VMs, 2-host cluster, Windows Datacenter

Metric	Hyper-V Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes
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Annual Windows Datacenter licensing	\$98,480	\$0	\$98,480	2 hosts x \$49K
Annual System Center	\$28,856	\$0	\$28,856	SCVMM + SCOM
Annual CALs (200 users)	\$6,000	\$0	\$6,000	Per-user CALs
Migration (one-time)	—	\$12,000	-\$12,000	
Annual savings			\$133,336	
3-year net savings			\$388,008	

Scenario 7: Edge Deployment — 50 sites, VMware to K3s + KubeVirt

Metric	VMware	K3s + KubeVirt	Savings	Notes
Annual software per site	\$10,000	\$0	\$10,000	vSphere Essentials
50 sites annual software	\$500,000	\$0	\$500,000	
Management (vCenter vs GitOps)	\$50,000	\$0	\$50,000	ArgoCD is free
Migration (one-time, all sites)	—	\$30,000	-\$30,000	Convert once, deploy to all
Annual savings			\$550,000	
3-year net savings			\$1,620,000	

Combined Scenario

The complete picture: VMware + Hyper-V + cloud + edge + SQL in one migration project.

Scenario 8: Full Migration — 200 VMs across VMware, Hyper-V, AWS, Azure + 20 edge sites + SQL Server

Component	VMs	Current Annual	KVM Annual	Annual Savings
VMware vSphere (100 VMs, 8 hosts)	100	\$280,000	\$6,400	\$273,600
Hyper-V (40 VMs, 2 hosts)	40	\$133,336	\$0	\$133,336
AWS EC2 (30 VMs)	30	\$264,000	\$20,000	\$244,000
Azure (30 VMs)	30	\$234,000	\$20,000	\$214,000
Edge sites (20 sites, VMware)	—	\$200,000	\$0	\$200,000
SQL Server licensing (10 instances)	—	\$632,400	\$379,440	\$252,960
Subtotal — current annual	200	\$1,743,736	\$425,840	\$1,317,896

Investment	Amount	Notes
Migration labor (2 engineers, 20 weeks)	\$60,000	hyper2kvm + hypersdk automate most work
New hardware (edge + expansion)	\$40,000	Mini PCs for edge, reuse existing for HQ
Training (Linux/KVM/K8s)	\$15,000	Team upskilling
hyper2kvm + hypersdk	\$0	Apache 2.0 — free forever
Total one-time investment	\$115,000	

\$1.32M

Annual savings

1.0 mo

Payback period

\$3.84M

3-year net savings

3,339%

3-year ROI

\$3.84M Saved Over 3 Years — \$115K Investment

Payback in 1 month. Every additional month is pure savings.

VMware licensing: gone. Hyper-V licensing: gone. Cloud bills: slashed 85%.

SQL Server licensing: reduced 40%. Edge sites: \$0 software forever.

hyper2kvm + hypersdk made it possible — for \$0 in tool cost.

hyper2kvm + hypersdk — Enterprise VM Migration Platform | Apache 2.0 Open Source | github.com/ssahani/hyper2kvm